

Gaming and the Environment when reflecting on AI

Posted by u/Immediate_Agency5442 • 0 points • 19 comments

<https://i.redd.it/ecy4kafzm8ye1.gif>

Fact Check for All You “AI Ruins the Planet” Gamers

Let's talk hypocrisy real quick. You wag a finger at AI over energy use, valid concern. But then you fire up your RTX 4090, a card that gulps 450 watts when running maxed-out ray tracing. That's more than your fridge on full blast.

- * 2.69 billion gamers globally as of end of 2020
- * Video game industry environmental impact is rising, including:
 - * Mining materials for consoles: copper, nickel, gold, zinc
 - * Energy demands of cloud gaming
 - * Data usage contributing to internet pollution
- * Cloud gaming uses 156% more energy than local gaming
- * U.S. gamers burn through 34 terawatt-hours of electricity annually.
- * That RTX 4090 DOES suck down 450 watts when you're pushing those ray-traced pixels at it's peaks—more than your damn refrigerator at full blast. The 34 terawatt-hours for U.S. gamers annually? Based Lawrence Berkeley Lab confirmed it = to 5 million cars.
- * That's equal to running 5 million cars a year. (Source: Lawrence Berkeley Lab.)
- * Every new console generation?
 - * Millions of outdated machines headed straight to the landfill in under 5 years.
 - * Sony estimates a single PS5 emits 87kg of CO₂—before it's even turned on.
- * Global e-waste recycling rate? Around 17%-25%
 - * Every console generation = millions of machines heading to the landfill in 5 years.
 - * Sony admits each PS5 creates about 87kg of carbon into the atmosphere BEFORE you even plug it in.
 - * 50 million metric tons annually (UN estimate)
- * [<https://earth.org/sustainability-and-the-video-gaming-industry/>]
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Look, I'm not trying to make you feel bad for gaming. It's a passion. So is art. So is tech. But if you're gonna call AI “the end of the world,” maybe take a look in the mirror:

- * Cut down your meat intake

- * Actually recycle your old hardware
- * Maybe don't game 40 hours a week while yelling about energy use
- * Focus on what you control before trying to gatekeep what others create
- * Consider how you use AI or support it.

Gen-AI isn't the here villain. It's a tool. Like your GPU. Like your console. The real test is how you choose to use it—or waste it.

Comments

u/Snoo93629 • -1 points • 2025-05-02 05:08 UTC

So because I use an older computer and game moderately, I do get to still hate on you for using AI, right? Or, no, that's probably not what you meant

u/Agile-Music-2295 • 3 points • 2025-05-02 02:13 UTC

Good point but the real villains of the environment is Pixar studios.

Pixar has a huge "render farm," which is basically a supercomputer composed of 2000 machines, and 24,000 cores. This makes it one of the 25 largest supercomputers in the world. That said, with all that computing power, it still took two years to render *Monsters University*.
— Peter Collingridge

It can take 24 hours to render 1 frame of their movies. Every second has upto 24 frames.

Alternatively AI uses far less energy and can render 1 second in as little as 4 minutes.

u/Immediate_Agency5442 • 1 points • 2025-05-02 02:29 UTC

Is this true?

u/RodrigoF • 7 points • 2025-05-02 01:21 UTC

Me, using AI, eating steaks and gaming all night:

Very interesting

u/ifandbut • 1 points • 2025-05-02 13:02 UTC

Same here.

I acknowledge the environmental impact of me existing and consuming in the 21st century. I support alternatives like clean and nuke energy, lab grown meat, hydroponics, etc. Through those technologies we can keep or improve our standards of living while reducing the environmental cost.

u/Immediate_Agency5442 • 3 points • 2025-05-02 01:23 UTC

I mean for the kill shot?

u/swanlongjohnson • -5 points • 2025-05-02 01:05 UTC

this was written by chatgpt, very obvious. how far will laziness go?

u/Immediate_Agency5442 • 8 points • 2025-05-02 01:16 UTC

It is literally bullet points and date research. You can dismiss it or you can consider it. You are not adding much value.

u/swanlongjohnson • -4 points • 2025-05-02 04:14 UTC

cant even articulate your own thoughts its pathetic. i will not trust AI as a source nor should anybody

u/NegativeEmphasis • 2 points • 2025-05-02 19:35 UTC

I'm enjoying immensely how a part of humanity decided to stupidify themselves on purpose, since now organized, well punctuated text is "a sign of AI".

u/swanlongjohnson • -1 points • 2025-05-02 19:48 UTC

this comment reeks of low IQ considering the OP admitted it was AI a comment above

u/CriminalCrime1 • 2 points • 2025-05-02 17:33 UTC

>cant even articulate your own thoughts its pathetic

Organizing thoughts is bad now?

u/throwawayRoar20s • 8 points • 2025-05-01 23:39 UTC

Sitting on your ass and playing video games is not being productive either.

u/SolidCake • 3 points • 2025-05-02 09:20 UTC

You are only allowed to use electricity productively ?

u/OkAsk1472 • -7 points • 2025-05-01 23:32 UTC

Honestly, these "whataboutism" arguments really just make me think the arguer has no good point to make.

u/Viktor_smg • 4 points • 2025-05-02 02:59 UTC

No one actually cares about the environment (or enslaved kids, for that matter). But because no one will admit that and people will pretend to sorta but not really care, you still end up not getting completely ignored. In reality, it's a non-argument to pretty much everyone, it only exists to virtue signal and comparisons like this point it out without explicitly saying no one cares.

u/Immediate_Agency5442 • 8 points • 2025-05-02 00:07 UTC

Pat.

The people shouting "AI is killing the planet" aren't applying that same energy to their own hobbies.

That's all I'm doing — holding up a mirror to the community. You can't look at things in a silo.

u/10luoz • -1 points • 2025-05-01 21:45 UTC

Some questionable retorts.

If you play games on your smartphone then they consider you a gamer.

a lot of the same problems with the gaming industry apply to GPUs used to train AI models.

I do question on the console to landfill in 5 years? People keep their consoles a lot longer unless it breaks. (it not like people are not trying to buy older consoles for nostalgia sake)

Gpu also have a lifespan of 3-5 years. And just looking at a materials perspective, there is a lot more stuff that goes into a AI-ready data center PC than just an equivalent console.

an

u/Immediate_Agency5442 • 4 points • 2025-05-01 21:54 UTC

GREAT! if mobile gamers are counted that increase the foot print not decreases so how bad are smart phones.

- * On average, people get a new phone every 2 to 3 years, though it varies by region and income level.
- * iPhone users tend to keep phones slightly longer (~2.8 years)
- * Android users replace slightly more often (~2.4 years), depending on brand and update support
- * Manufacturing Emissions: Producing a new smartphone generates approximately 60–85 kg of CO₂-equivalent emissions, with 95% of these emissions occurring before the device is even turned on.
- * Annual Usage Emissions: Using a smartphone for one hour daily over a year results in about 63 kg of CO₂ emissions, primarily due to energy consumption and data usage
- * Data Center Impact: The energy required to support smartphone activities—like gaming, streaming, and app usage—significantly contributes to the carbon footprint, as data centers consume substantial electricity to store and process data.
- * E-Waste Concerns: In 2022 alone, an estimated 5 billion smartphones were discarded, many ending up in landfills, exacerbating environmental pollution.

Great we can exchange the data on these things.

u/Immediate_Agency5442 • 4 points • 2025-05-01 21:50 UTC

Sure, GPUs can be resold or repurposed—but they usually aren't. You're just pushing sand here. The point is: gaming isn't good for the environment either, you just look the other way. That's called cherry-picking.